STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURES • KENYA

Sphere Pharmacy Operations & Staff Manual

A comprehensive standard operating guide for online dispensary operations, clinical prescription verification, multi-channel payment reconciliation, and courier dispatch management.

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REGULATORY COMPLIANCE
Pharmacy and Poisons Board (PPB) Kenya

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AUTHORIZED PERSONNEL
Admin, Pharmacist, Staff & Dispatch Rider

Operational Core Values: Patient Safety & Financial Accuracy
Every prescription handled and every payment processed must strictly follow documented verification steps. Never dispense prescription-only medications without licensed pharmacist approval, and never mark orders as paid without provider-confirmed receipts.

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📋 Quick Reference & Role Responsibilities

This manual defines standard workflows for the Sphere Pharmacy web platform. Use this matrix to understand permissions, core duties, and navigation across the operational lifecycle.

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Role Accountability Matrix

ROLE	CORE RESPONSIBILITIES	KEY SYSTEM SECTIONS
ADMIN	Complete executive business control, pricing, settings, reports, audit logs, staff provisioning, promotions, compliance, and refunds.	Overview, Orders, Prescriptions, Dispatch, Catalogue, Bookings, Staff, Settings, Reports, Audit Log
PHARMACIST	Prescription clinical verification, dispensing authorization, order fulfillment review, catalogue review, care clinic appointments, customer clinical reviews.	Prescriptions, Orders, Dispatch, Catalogue, Bookings, Services, Reviews
STAFF	Over-the-counter order packing, inventory restocking, pickup handover, in-store payment collection, promotions oversight, service scheduling.	Orders, Dispatch, Catalogue, Promotions, Bookings, Services
RIDER	View assigned delivery manifests, confirm destination customer address/phone, initiate delivery transit, record physical completion handover.	Dispatch, My Deliveries

🔒 **Zero-Sharing Account Policy**

Never share staff accounts or master passwords. Every action is permanently recorded in the system audit log with actor name, role, IP, and timestamp.

1 Daily Starting Point & Sign-In Protocol

Every morning, authorized personnel must initiate their operational session through the following standard procedure:

1. **Access Staff Portal:** Open the pharmacy website, scroll to the footer and click **Staff Dashboard**, or navigate directly to `/admin`.
2. **Staff Authentication:** Click **Sign in as staff** and provide your dedicated staff email and secure password.
3. **Identity & Role Verification:** Check the top-right header to confirm that your displayed name and assigned badge (Admin, Pharmacist, Staff, or Rider) match your identity.
4. **Cache Synchronization:** Click the circular **Refresh** button in the top navigation bar to load live database state.
5. **Push Alerts Activation:** Click **Enable push alerts** on compatible browsers to ensure real-time audio-visual notifications for new incoming orders and urgent prescription uploads.

2 Storefront Navigation & Customer Flow

Staff members must understand customer touchpoints to provide seamless telephone, WhatsApp, and walk-in guidance:

🛍️ Customer Storefront

Home: Featured medicines, emergency contacts, opening hours.
Shop: Searchable categorized catalogue with live stock badges.
Upload Prescription: Direct upload portal for photos & PDF files.
Care Services: Clinic appointment booking with time slots.

👤 Customer Hub & Support

My Orders: Real-time stage tracking with pickup codes.
Account: Address management, loyalty points, refill reminders.
Cart & Wishlist: Saved items and active order preparation.
WhatsApp / Direct Call: Instant links for direct pharmacist consultation.

3 Morning 8-Point Operational Audit

The Admin or Lead Pharmacist must complete these checks before commencing daily dispensing:

- [ ] **1. Overview Dashboard:** Review today's sales velocity, revenue metrics, active prescription queue count, and inventory health graph.
- [ ] **2. Order Processing Queue:** Open **Admin** → **Orders** and triage all overnight orders.
- [ ] **3. Prescription Backlog:** Open **Admin** → **Prescriptions** and prioritize unreviewed customer prescription uploads.
- [ ] **4. Dispatch Board:** Check **Admin** → **Dispatch** for orders awaiting rider assignment.
- [ ] **5. Clinic Appointments:** Check **Admin** → **Bookings** for patient consultations or clinic services scheduled for the day.
- [ ] **6. Inventory Status:** Filter **Catalogue** by "Low Stock" and "Out of Stock" to prepare vendor replenishment orders.
- [ ] **7. Notification Inbox:** Address unread payment confirmation flags or failed delivery alerts.
- [ ] **8. Browser Refresh:** Press refresh after cross-staff shifts to ensure synchronized inventory and transaction versions.

4 Order Lifecycle & Management Workflow

All orders must progress sequentially through the verified platform pipeline. Strict state validation prevents orders from jumping stages without fulfillment checks.

STANDARD ORDER FULFILLMENT PIPELINE

1. Received → **2. Under Review** → **3. Stock Confirmed** → **4. Awaiting Payment** → **5. Paid** → **6. Preparing** → **7. Ready / Transit** → **8. Completed**

Step-by-Step Processing Guide

1. **Locate & Open:** Search by 6-character order reference (e.g. `SPH-4829`), customer name, or filter by status.
2. **Physical Stock Audit:** Confirm that physical shelf stock matches the cart quantities before confirming availability.
3. **Fulfillment Triage:** Verify whether the order is **Pharmacy Pickup** or **Doorstep Delivery**. Confirm delivery zone and area notes.
4. **Prescription Orders:** If items require a prescription, the order moves to `Prescription Verified` only after a licensed pharmacist approves the upload.
5. **Status Advancement:** Click the next available status button. Always append a concise note whenever explaining delays or pickup instructions to the customer.

🛑 Order Cancellation Protocol

1. Open the active order in Admin.
2. Click **Cancel Order**.
3. Enter a mandatory audit reason.
4. Confirm once.

The system automatically restocks inventory, refunds redeemed loyalty points, and dispatches a notification to the customer.

⏰ Automatic Reservation Expiry

Orders held in `AWAITING_PAYMENT` or `RECEIVED` status are held for a designated window (default 30–60 mins). If unpaid, the system automatically releases reserved stock and cancels the order to prevent shelf stockouts.

💡 **Fulfillment Hygiene & Concurrency Rule:**
If an order was recently updated by another staff member, you may see a "Write Conflict" notice. Simply refresh the page (`Ctrl+F5`) to inspect the latest state before reapplying your action. Never double-click fulfillment buttons.

5 Payment Verification & Refund Procedures

All financial transactions must be verified through automated gateways or verified cash-in-hand before any medicine is dispensed or released.

🚨 **Anti-Fraud Warning: Never Dispense on Screenshots**
Fraudulent customers frequently generate counterfeit M-Pesa SMS messages or fake banking screenshots. Dispense medicine ONLY when the order status displays `PAID` in green on your dashboard with a validated provider receipt number.

Payment Method Standard Operating Procedures

📱 M-Pesa Express (STK Push)

1. Open the order in **Admin** → **Orders**.
2. Confirm the customer's Safaricom phone number.
3. Click **Initiate M-Pesa Prompt**.
4. Instruct customer to enter their PIN on their phone.
5. Wait for Daraja API callback (status auto-updates to `PAID`).

If pending after 60s, click "Query Status" once. Do not re-trigger rapidly.

💳 Card & Digital Payments (IntaSend)

1. Customer initiates card/bank payment via hosted checkout.
2. Customer completes 3D-Secure authentication.
3. IntaSend webhook automatically marks the order `PAID`.
4. If customer claims success but dashboard says pending, check the IntaSend merchant portal before manual intervention.

💵 Cash on Delivery / Counter Pickup

1. Collect the physical Kenya Shillings before dispensing.
2. Count and inspect notes for authenticity.
3. Authorized staff clicks **Confirm Cash Payment**.
4. *Strict Rule:* Only the staff member or rider who physically holds the cash may confirm the cash action.

↩️ Refund & Point Clawback Protocol

1. Open the completed order and payment record.
2. Enter the mandatory clinical/business refund reason.
3. Click **Process Refund** (confirm once).
4. Provider returns funds, redeemed points restore, and awarded loyalty points claw back.

Never double-click refund buttons under any circumstance.

Verification & Settlement Matrix

CHANNEL	STANDARD OPERATIONAL PROCEDURE	VERIFICATION RULE
M-Pesa Express	Trigger STK push from order details. Instruct customer to input PIN. System queries Daraja API.	Wait for auto-update to `PAID`. Receipt format: `QJK389...`. Do not retry repeatedly within 60 seconds.
Card (IntaSend)	Customer completes 3D-Secure card payment via secure checkout.	Webhook automatically updates payment to `SUCCESS`. Verify IntaSend portal if discrepancy occurs.
Cash on Delivery	Collect physical Kenya Shillings before handing over the package.	Authorized staff clicks **Confirm Cash Payment**. Only staff/rider who physically received the money may click this.
Refund Protocol	Admin opens completed payment, enters reason, and triggers refund.	Refund returns funds via provider, claws back loyalty points earned, and records audit trail. *Never double-click refund.*

💰 **End-of-Day Cash Till Balancing:**
At shift closing, the cash in the drawer must exactly match total orders confirmed as `CASH`. Any discrepancy must be logged immediately in the physical handover book.

6 Clinical Prescription Review & Dispensing

Prescription verification is a regulated clinical procedure under the Pharmacy and Poisons Board (PPB). Only licensed **Pharmacists** and authorized **Superintendent Admins** may approve prescriptions.

PRESCRIPTION DECISION MATRIX

1. Inspect Image / PDF → 2. Clinical Evaluation → **3. Pharmacist Action** → 4. Order Unlocked for Fulfillment

The 4 Official Review Decisions

DECISION	CLINICAL CRITERIA	ACTION & OUTCOME
APPROVE	Valid doctor credentials, signature/stamp, patient name matches, date within valid timeframe, dosage & frequency clear and clinically safe.	Set allowed refills & valid days. Order transitions to `Prescription Verified` and unlocks payment/dispatch.
PARTIALLY APPROVE	Prescription contains multiple items, but some are out of stock, unauthorized, or dosage requires doctor clarification.	Specify approved quantities and medicines in review notes. Non-approved lines are removed from final billing.
REQUEST CLARIFICATION	Image is blurry, cut off, date missing, or prescriber stamp illegible.	Customer receives notification requesting a clearer re-upload. Order remains on hold without cancellation.
REJECT	Expired prescription, obvious forgery, unauthorized controlled substance request, or doctor signature missing.	Order is cancelled. Customer receives professional explanation. System records clinical audit record.

💡 **Standard Clarification Message Template:**
"Dear Customer, we are unable to process your prescription because the prescriber stamp and dosage are cut off in the uploaded image. Please upload a clear, full-page photo of the prescription via your Account → Prescriptions portal."

7 Dispatch & Rider Logistics Workflow

Doorstep delivery orders must be dispatched systematically to preserve package security and cold-chain integrity where applicable.

📦 Dispatcher / Staff Duty

1. Ensure order is in `PAID` or authorized `CASH_ON_DELIVERY` state.
2. Pack medicines securely in tamper-evident packaging.
3. Open **Admin** → **Dispatch**.
4. Select order, click **Assign Rider**, and pick an active rider.
5. Hand package to rider only after assignment reflects on their device.

🛵 Delivery Rider Protocol

1. Log in on mobile at `/admin` and view **My Deliveries**.
2. Confirm delivery destination address and customer contact phone.
3. Tap **Start Delivery** upon departing pharmacy.
4. Verify customer identity upon arrival.
5. If cash delivery: collect cash first.
6. Tap **Mark Delivered** immediately after physical handover.

8 Catalogue & Stock Management

Maintaining 100% stock accuracy prevents customer frustration, cart abandonments, and overselling.

1. **Product Onboarding:** Open **Admin** → **Catalogue**. Enter Brand/Generic Name, SKU, category, unit price, pack size, and description. Upload clean square imagery.
2. **Prescription Flag:** Toggle **Requires Prescription** for all Prescription-Only Medicines (POM). This triggers mandatory pharmacist verification at checkout.
3. **Low Stock Threshold:** Set the threshold (e.g. 5 units). The system alerts staff on the dashboard when stock dips below this limit.
4. **Automated Restock Alerts:** When replenishing an out-of-stock product, the system automatically dispatches email and push notifications to all customers who clicked "Notify Me When Available".

9 Promotions & Customer Reviews

🏷️ Promotional Campaigns

• Create coupon codes in **Admin** → **Promotions**.
• Set start/end dates, minimum spend, percentage or fixed discount, and per-user usage limits.
• Always test coupon code on storefront before announcing to marketing channels.
• Deactivate expired promotional campaigns promptly.

⭐ Review Moderation

• Open **Admin** → **Reviews** to inspect feedback.
• Public reviews help build customer trust.
• Hide reviews containing spam, vulgarity, or personal health disclosures.
• Never hide honest constructive feedback regarding fulfillment speed; use it to improve service.

10 Customer Support Security Standards

🛡️ **Customer Privacy & Security Directives:**

1.
NEVER ask for customer passwords or SMS OTP codes.
Staff never need passwords to assist customers.
2. Always verify customer identity using Order Reference (`SPH-XXXX`) and registered phone number.
3. Do not disclose patient prescription history to third parties (family members, couriers, or callers) without explicit customer consent.

11 Care Services & Clinic Appointments

Sphere Pharmacy provides in-person health services (e.g., Blood Pressure Screening, Diabetes Consultation, Medication Therapy Review).

📅 **Triage Booking Calendar:** Open **Admin** → **Bookings** daily. Filter by today's date to see scheduled arrival slots.

🩺 **Patient Arrival:** Mark booking as `Arrived` , then `In Progress` when consultation begins.

✅ **Payment & Completion:** Confirm payment status (Prepaid online or Pay at Pharmacy). Mark booking as `Completed` upon conclusion.

12 Staff Account Administration

Staff permissions must adhere to the principle of least privilege. Accounts must be provisioned and decommissioned immediately upon personnel changes.

1. **Creation:** Admin opens **Admin** → **Staff**. Enter official name, professional email, and role.
2. **First Login:** Issue a strong temporary password and require the employee to change it immediately in **Account** → **Security**.
3. **Deactivation:** When an employee departs, takes leave, or transitions roles, immediately toggle their account status to **Inactive**. Do not delete records to maintain audit log history.

13 Store Settings & Regulatory Compliance

⚙️ Pharmacy Profile & Delivery

Manage physical address, phone lines, emergency WhatsApp numbers, operating hours, delivery base fees, and free-delivery cart thresholds in **Admin** → **Settings**.

📜 PPB Compliance & Licencing

Keep the Pharmacy and Poisons Board (PPB) premises licence number and Superintendent Pharmacist registration number up to date in **Admin** → **Compliance**.

14 Financial Reports & Audit Trails

Financial and inventory reports in **Admin** → **Reports** provide vital business intelligence:

- 📊 **Sales Reconciliation:** Cross-check total daily platform revenue against physical cash collected and M-Pesa/IntaSend settlement accounts.
- 🔍 **Audit Trail Monitoring:** The **Audit Log** tracks all critical mutations (status overrides, price adjustments, stock manual edits, role escalations, and refunds) with actor ID and timestamp.

15 Notifications & Provider Health

The system features an automated asynchronous notification queue supporting In-App, Email (Resend), Web Push (Firebase), and transactional SMS.

> 🔔 **Notification Health Check:**
> Staff can monitor delivery health at `/api/admin/notification-health`. If customers report missing emails or push alerts, verify that browser notification permissions are granted and the Resend/Firebase credentials are operational.

16 Rapid Operational Troubleshooting Matrix

Consult this reference guide to resolve common storefront and admin challenges immediately:

ISSUE ENCOUNTERED	PROBABLE ROOT CAUSE	IMMEDIATE CORRECTIVE ACTION
Dashboard data appears stale	Browser tab backgrounded or local cache holding previous state.	Click the circular **Refresh** button in top header bar or press `Ctrl+F5`.
Newly placed order not visible	Active status filters (e.g. filtered to "Preparing") hiding new "Received" orders.	Clear all status/date filters in **Admin** → **Orders** and refresh.
M-Pesa payment shows "Pending"	Customer has not entered PIN, or Safaricom callback is processing.	Do NOT mark order as paid manually. Wait up to 60s, then click "Query Status". Dispense only when status becomes `PAID`.
Customer shows payment screenshot	Potential SMS spoofing, delayed webhook, or payment to incorrect Paybill.	Verify against M-Pesa statement/portal. Never advance order status based on customer device display alone.
Prescription photo unreadable	Poor lighting, camera shake, or cropped edges.	Click **Request Clarification**. Provide specific guidance on what part of document is missing.
Rider cannot see delivery order	Order was not assigned, or assigned to a different rider account.	Open **Admin** → **Dispatch**, verify rider assignment, reassign if needed, and have rider refresh app.
Product shows "Out of Stock" after restock	Quantity was saved as 0 or stock status flag was not recalculated.	Open product in catalogue, verify stock quantity is greater than 0, save, and refresh public shop page.
Bulk CSV product upload failed	Mismatched column headers, duplicate SKUs, or non-numeric prices.	Check error modal for specific row numbers. Correct errors in CSV spreadsheet and re-import only corrected rows.
Push alerts stopped ringing	Browser permissions revoked or device token expired.	Click lock icon next to browser URL, ensure "Notifications: Allow" is active, and re-click "Enable Push Alerts".
Write Conflict / Database Error	Two staff members simultaneously updated the same order record.	Refresh the page to view current database version, then re-apply your status change.

17 End-of-Day Closing Audit Checklist

The closing pharmacist and floor supervisor must verify each of the following items prior to shutting down operations:

- [ ] **All New Orders Processed:** Zero orders remain in unattended `RECEIVED` or `UNDER_REVIEW` status.
- [ ] **Paid Orders Dispatched:** All orders marked `PAID` have either been dispatched with riders or placed in the pickup collection station.
- [ ] **Prescription Queue Cleared:** Every uploaded prescription has an approved decision, partial approval, or clarification request note.
- [ ] **Delivery Reconciliation:** All active delivery riders have marked completed deliveries or checked in packages that require re-attempt.
- [ ] **Cash Till Balancing:** Total collected physical cash precisely reconciles with orders marked `CASH` on the dashboard.
- [ ] **Failed/Expired Order Audit:** Expired reservation items have been verified and returned to physical shelf stock.
- [ ] **Tomorrow's Bookings Checked:** Patient appointment schedule for the following morning has been reviewed.
- [ ] **Security Sign-Out:** All staff members sign out of shared dispensary desktop computers and point-of-sale terminals.

18 The 10 Golden Rules of Business Protection

1. **Clinical Dispensing Primacy:** Never dispense Prescription-Only Medicines without verified pharmacist approval.
2. **Verified Payment Invariance:** Never mark an order as paid without an authorized provider transaction record.
3. **Credential Non-Proliferation:** Never share passwords, administrative PINs, or customer OTPs.
4. **Audit Log Integrity:** Never attempt to bypass or delete historical records. Rectify errors through documented workflows.
5. **Data Confidentiality:** Never export or distribute customer medical files, prescription images, or phone lists.
6. **Isolated Staging Testing:** Conduct platform tests and integration verifications in staging/sandbox environments only.
7. **Principle of Least Privilege:** Grant staff accounts only the permissions necessary for their direct job function.
8. **Physical Stock Alignment:** Reconcile shelf inventory immediately when catalogue quantities are adjusted.
9. **Customer Communication Hygiene:** Send polite, professional, and unambiguous notes when requesting clarifications.
10. **Swift Escalation:** Report suspected data breaches, payment gateway outages, or security anomalies immediately.

19 Technical Support Escalation Protocol

When escalating software anomalies or server disruptions to the technical administrator, provide:

```
INCIDENT ESCALATION TEMPLATE:
1. Affected Section / URL: [e.g. /admin/orders or /admin/prescriptions]
2. Staff Account & Role: [e.g. pharmacist@spherepharmacy.co.ke (Pharmacist)]
3. Reference ID: [e.g. Order #SPH-2849 or Prescription #rx-9182]
4. Exact Action Attempted: [e.g. Clicked 'Confirm Cash' on order]
5. Expected Behavior: [e.g. Order transitions to PAID status]
6. Observed Error / Behavior: [e.g. Error code P2034 / Write conflict toast]
7. Device & Browser: [e.g. Chrome 148 on Ubuntu / Safari on iPad iOS 18]
8. Exact Timestamp: [e.g. 2026-09-05 12:35 PM EAT]
```